

rid of that is to rehearse your presentation. This is generally called a dummy presentation. Here are some tips on how to cope with the presentation jitters before you actually make one!

1. Make sure you play an active part in preparing the presentation even if it is not required from you. If you are suddenly required to step into someone else's shoes, make sure you are ready for it.

2. Know the shortcut keys well and all the views in PowerPoint.

3. Rehearse, rehearse, rehearse. Consciously pay attention to your body language. Slouching, unnecessary hand gestures, wiping your face while speaking, all point to nervousness. Other tell-tale signs are fidgeting, playing with an object, and not making eye contact with the audience. Make sure that you avoid all this.

4. Avoid using filler words such as “umm” and “err” when making a presentation. If you do not remember what to say, pause your speech while you collect your thoughts.

5. Rehearse in front of colleagues or friends and ask them to point out your shortcomings. This will increase your confidence.

6. Know your subject matter inside out.

7. Use a wooden pointer or a laser or a pen to point to text or charts on the slide.



Slide Transitions

You can delve still deeper in PowerPoint 2003 and understand the finer details and intricacies that are hidden deeper within. PowerPoint 2003 gives you more power than ever before for improving your presentation skills, and there's no way you can mess up your presentation—even if it's your first one—unless you really intend to do so!